famous Brahmanical temple dedicated to the solar deity Aditya, and directly communicated with Zamindawar; Brahmanical trends thus easily traveled westward and likely resulted in derivative cults. For Multan's regional and transregional overland connections, see Deloche [1980] 1993/94: 26–27 and fig. II; Dani 1982; Rehman 1979: 66; Edwards 2006: 22; and esp. Chapter 6. The mutually augmentative nexus between pilgrimage and trade has been extensively studied, e.g., Ray (1996: 5 and *passim*).

58. Inaba 2013: 90; Rezakhani 2017: 140–145, 165–168; and Chapter 3. The commerce along these routes, moreover, invited raids by Ghuri tribesmen along the southern reaches of their own annual migrations. Cf. also Bosworth 1961: 118; Mahmud 2009: 54; and Chapter 1.
59. Cf. Anon., *Tarikh-i Sistan* (trans. Gold) 1976: 74–75, 86–87, 101, 111, 114, 119, 167, 170–172, 216. Apparently, when central Umayyad demands became oppressive, there were even periodic alliances between local Arab forces and the Rutbil (see ibid., esp. 89–96, 163–164). See also Bosworth 1968a: 34–36, 121; Ball and Fischer 2019: 460; Ball 2020.
60. Michailidis 2015: 136. See also Ball 2020. Later patrons "could have indeed understood [the motifs] to reflect an earlier tradition" (M. Canepa, pers. comm., February 2018). Parallel to Michailidis' characterization of the architectural patronage of the Bawandids (mid-seventh–fourteenth centuries), a similar continuity with Sasanian architecture was discernible in Ṭahirid (821–873) palatial constructions (cf. Finster 1994). Subsequently, the well-known Buwayhid (932–1062) inscriptions at Persepolis demonstrated the importance of pre-Islamic Iranian kingship especially for dynasties with local origins, including the adoption of titles such as *shahanshah*. Cf. Blair 1992: 32–37. See also Canepa's (2015: 92–99) analysis of Sasanian dynastic sanctuaries and the dissemination of "Iranian kingship as a global idiom of power." Finally, Bosworth (1968a: 23) confirmed the proclivity toward Sasanian imperial practices specifically in Sistan, where "the local consciousness … had strong feelings of solidarity with the ancient culture and traditions of Iran." See also *ibid.*, 35 for the prestige and emulation of the Sasanian empire throughout Central Asia during the centuries after its demise; and Bosworth 2008: 97ff. It should also be mentioned that Sasanian coinage types continued to be emulated in the empire's eastern lands, possibly as late as the eighth century (Rezakhani 2020).
61. Cf. Bosworth [1977] 1992: 68; and Introduction (notes).
62. In terms of architectural patronage, regional variations among the far-flung Saljuq domains were discernible for a variety of reasons, perhaps especially due to the increasing politico-economic fragmentation of the empire through the *iqta'* system (Peacock 2016: 19–21). Nevertheless, the *iqta'* holders, some becoming more independent of the Saljuq sultans over time, "also sought to enhance their own prestige by creating regional courts modeled on the Seljuk precedent, which acted as centers for artistic and cultural patronage" (*ibid.*, 15).
63. While the figure of the Jewish merchant from Firuzkuh has had multiple historical resonances – discussed forthwith – recent re-examination of the name "Banji" has also borne fruit as to its possible origins: analysis of pre-Islamic